

Ameiva polops

St. Croix ground lizard

Family (homeless)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered)

Description

A small lizard measuring 35–77 mm in snout-vent length. It has parallel longitudinal stripes of black, white, and light brown, with a light gray belly bordered by blue margins and pinkish undersides on the legs, throat, and chest. The tail shows alternating blue and black rings. Its reproductive biology is unknown.



Location/Habitat

Restricted to Green Cay and Protestant Cay (St. Croix), primarily in coastal beach areas and upland Hippomane–Tabebuia woodland. It uses habitats with a mix of open and shaded areas, including trees, leaf or tidal litter, loose soils, and crab burrows, with smaller individuals in exposed sites and larger ones in more canopied areas.

